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SINGAPORE · WEALTH MANAGEMENT · MARKET ANALYSIS 2026

Singapore wealth management 2026

Family office boom, VCC adoption, AML/CRS tightening, and the structural contest for regional HNWI capital.

GEOGRAPHY	INDUSTRY	PUBLICATION	PAGES
Singapore SG	Wealth Management	2026	14

Research approach and scope

This report covers Singapore's wealth management ecosystem — family offices, private banks, MAS regulatory developments, and the competitive dynamics with Hong Kong. Data horizon: 2020–2026E.

01

Primary regulatory sources

Our analysts drew directly from **MAS published statistics, circulars, and consultation papers** (2023–2025), including the Variable Capital Companies framework annual reports, AML/CFT guidelines MAS-CG-01, and the Fund Manager survey data. Tax incentive data sourced from EDB Singapore's Section 13O/13U incentive register disclosures.

02

Secondary and operator data

Private bank AUM estimates triangulated from **published annual reports** of DBS Private Bank, UBS Singapore, Julius Baer Asia, and Credit Suisse (pre-merger filings). VCC adoption rates cross-verified against Accounting and Corporate Regulatory Authority (ACRA) incorporation records. Offshore wealth data from Boston Consulting Group global wealth reports (BCG 2025).

03

Market sizing model

Total AUM under management constructed bottom-up: family office AUM × average fund size per MAS category, plus private bank AUM from operator filings, plus discretionary portfolio management. **HNWI population** figures use cap-wealth thresholds consistent with USD 1 mn+ investable assets. Kira estimates used for projections beyond 2025 declared data.

SOURCE KEY · **MAS 2025** = Monetary Authority of Singapore, Fund Manager Survey 2025 · **BCG 2025** = BCG Global Wealth Report 2025 · **ACRA 2025** = Accounting and Corporate Regulatory Authority, VCC Register

Table of contents

01 Executive summary — market at inflection 04

02 Strategic implications for market participants 05

03 Market size and AUM trajectory 06

04 Family office landscape — SFO and VCC structure 07

05 Regulatory environment — AML, CRS, and licensing 08

06 Private banking competitive landscape 09

07 Singapore vs Hong Kong: the capital war 10

08 Digital assets and tokenisation integration 11

09 Next-gen succession and family governance 12

10 Five-year outlook and risk scenarios 13

11 Source key and disclosures 14

Market at inflection: scale, compliance, and the next chapter

TOTAL AUM MANAGED IN SG	FAMILY OFFICES REGISTERED	VCC VEHICLES INCORPORATED	HNWI POPULATION (USD 1MN+)
SGD 5.4 trn	1,400 +	1,100 +	240 K
+10.8% YoY 2024, structural inflow	From ~700 in 2020, doubling in 4 yr	+38% YoY 2024; 67% are FO vehicles	+6.2% YoY; density highest in ASEAN
MAS 2025	MAS 2025	ACRA 2025	KIRA ESTIMATES

Structural inflows persist despite tighter compliance

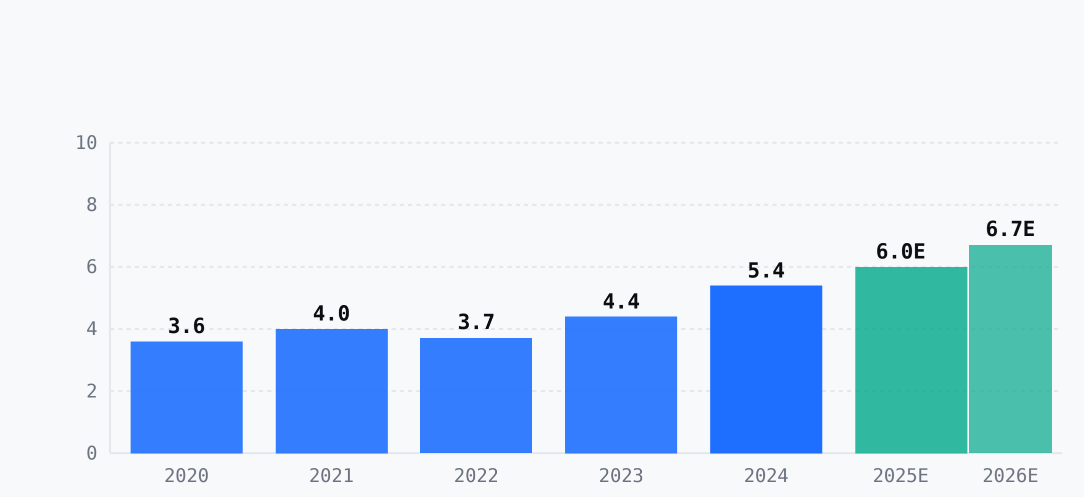
Singapore's managed asset base reached **SGD 5.4 trn** at end-2024 [MAS 2025], up from SGD 3.6 trn in 2020 — a compound annual expansion of roughly 10% driven predominantly by Southeast Asian, North Asian, and South Asian HNWI relocations, not by domestic wealth creation. The city-state now hosts more registered family offices than any other Asian centre.

VCC is redefining the structuring landscape

The Variable Capital Company framework, launched in 2020, has **catalysed 1,100+ vehicles** [ACRA 2025] — the majority used by single-family offices and fund managers as a more flexible alternative to Cayman structures. Pass-through tax treatment combined with Singapore's DTA network of 93 agreements [IRAS 2025] gives the VCC a structuring edge no rival jurisdiction yet matches at scale.

Singapore AUM growth trajectory

SGD TRN · 2020–2026E · ALL MANAGED ASSETS



SOURCE: MAS FUND MANAGER SURVEY 2025 · KIRA ESTIMATES FOR 2025E–2026E

SOURCE KEY · **MAS 2025** = MAS Fund Manager Survey 2025 · **ACRA 2025** = ACRA VCC Register 2025 · **IRAS 2025** = Inland Revenue Authority, DTA Schedule

Five strategic implications for market participants

Derived from the structural trends in this report — relevant to private banks, family offices, fund managers, legal/accounting service providers, and technology vendors operating in or targeting Singapore's wealth ecosystem.

01

Institutionalise compliance before 2027 tightening

MAS's AML/CFT fourth round mutual evaluation arrives in 2026–27. Family offices without dedicated compliance officers and documented source-of-wealth procedures face **license suspension risk** under revised MAS Notice CMG-N02. The window to embed institutional-grade KYC is narrowing fast.

Anchor: **SGD 5.4 trn** AUM under enhanced scrutiny [MAS 2025]

02

VCC structures outcompete Cayman for ASEAN-facing families

For families whose investable assets are predominantly deployed in Southeast Asia, the VCC offers **lower formation cost, Singapore DTA access, and pass-through treatment** that Cayman cannot replicate post-BEPS Pillar Two. Early movers are locking in structure optionality before potential carve-outs tighten.

Anchor: **1,100+** VCCs incorporated [ACRA 2025]

03

Digital assets custody is an emerging competitive differentiator

Of 1,400+ family offices, approximately **35–40% hold or plan to hold digital assets** within 18 months [Kira estimates]. Private banks that can offer MAS-licensed custody (under the Payment Services Act digital token provisions) alongside traditional portfolios will capture wallet share from those that cannot.

Anchor: **35–40%** FO digital asset allocation intent [Kira estimates]

04

Sequence next-gen engagement before succession becomes crisis

An estimated **60% of Asia's ultra-HNW wealth will transfer generationally by 2035** [BCG 2025]. Family offices whose governance frameworks do not encompass G2/G3 voice — investment committee representation, family charters, and conflict resolution protocols — face asset outflow at the point of succession.

Anchor: **60%** wealth transfer by 2035 [BCG 2025]

05

Singapore's lead over Hong Kong is structural, not cyclical

Post-2020 capital and talent flows have entrenched **Singapore's institutional infrastructure advantage**: legal system, talent pool, technology ecosystem. Hong Kong's recovery targets primarily mainland-linked capital — a different flow than the South/Southeast Asian and global diaspora capital anchored in Singapore.

Anchor: **SG 1,400+** vs HK ~**2,700** FOs — different capital profiles

SOURCE KEY · **MAS 2025** = MAS Fund Manager Survey · **BCG 2025** = BCG Global Wealth Report 2025 · **ACRA 2025** = ACRA VCC Register

SECTION 03–04

Market size & family offices

SGD 5.4 trn in managed assets, 1,400+ family offices, and a VCC framework that is rewriting structuring economics across the region. The volume is no longer the story — it is the composition that matters for competitive positioning.

AUM TRAJECTORY

SFO / MFO SPLIT

VCC ADOPTION

TAX INCENTIVES

AUM at SGD 5.4 trn: concentration, composition, and trajectory

TOTAL AUM 2024	PE & VC AUM SHARE	NON-RESIDENT AUM SHARE	FUND MANAGERS LICENSED
SGD 5.4 trn	19 %	76 %	1,100 +
+10.8% YoY	SGD ~1.03 trn; fastest-growing segment	Offshore capital dominant	Licensed CMS holders (LFMC + RFMC)
[MAS 2025]	[MAS 2025]	[MAS 2025]	[MAS 2025]

SEGMENT COMPOSITION

The SGD 5.4 trn headline encompasses traditional long-only (41%), private equity and venture (19%), real assets (14%), hedge funds (11%), and a residual 15% in multi-asset / liquid alternatives [MAS 2025]. The private equity share has expanded from 11% in 2020, driven predominantly by Southeast Asian growth equity mandates and USD-denominated global PE feeder structures routed through Singapore GPs.

Traditional long-only AUM is growing more slowly — **+4.2% CAGR 2020–2024** — as fee compression and passive substitution affect institutional mandates. Real assets (infrastructure, real estate, timberland) are the emerging store-of-wealth category for family offices, growing at +18% CAGR over the same period [Kira estimates based on MAS data].

GEOGRAPHIC SOURCE OF FUNDS

Southeast Asia accounts for 28% of non-resident AUM origin, followed by Greater China (24%), South Asia (16%), Europe (14%), and the Americas (10%) [MAS 2025]. The Southeast Asian share has been the fastest-growing since 2022, reflecting both Indonesian and Vietnamese entrepreneur liquidity events and intergenerational wealth transfer structuring.

OUTLOOK TO 2028

Our analysts project Singapore's total managed AUM reaching **SGD 8.5–9.0 trn by 2028** [Kira estimates], assuming MAS compliance framework remains stable and the city-state continues to attract South and Southeast Asian HNWI relocations. The key variable is not AUM growth rate but manager quality density — Singapore risks shallow talent-per-AUM ratios if family office formation continues at current pace without commensurate investment professional hiring.

The 2022 market correction (SGD 3.7 trn, -7.5% YoY) confirmed that Singapore's AUM is not immune to global risk-off. However, the recovery speed — returning to SGD 4.4 trn by end-2023 — reflects the **structural stickiness of domiciled family office assets**, which do not redeem on volatility the way traditional fund capital does. This structural composition differentiates Singapore's AUM resilience from pure fund-hub models.

FEE ECONOMICS

Average management fee across licensed managers: 0.65–0.85% for traditional long-only, 1.5–2.0% plus performance for private markets [Kira estimates]. Family offices operating as registered fund management companies (RFMCs) face no external fee pressure — fee rates are an internal transfer price — which insulates aggregate AUM economics from the margin compression affecting publicly marketed funds.

SOURCE KEY · **MAS 2025** = MAS Fund Manager Survey 2025 — includes all licensed and registered fund managers

Family office landscape: SFO growth, VCC adoption, and the S13O/13U incentive regime

SCALE AND STRUCTURE

Singapore's registered family office count crossed 1,400 in 2024, up from approximately 700 in 2020 [MAS 2025]. **Single-family offices (SFOs) account for roughly 78%** of the total — these are entities managing assets of a single family, typically structured as a company or a VCC sub-fund [Kira estimates based on MAS/ACRA disclosures]. Multi-family offices (MFOs) number approximately 300–310, operating under licensed CMS holder status.

Average AUM per SFO is estimated at SGD 220–280 mn [Kira estimates], with the top decile exceeding SGD 1 bn. The median SFO holds a portfolio of 40–60% equities (mix of public and private), 20–30% fixed income and alternatives, and 10–15% in real assets including Singapore and regional property.

VCC FRAMEWORK — RAPID ADOPTION

The Variable Capital Company structure, introduced under the Variable Capital Companies Act 2018 (effective 2020), reached **1,100+ incorporated vehicles by end-2024** [ACRA 2025]. Approximately 67% are used as single or umbrella fund vehicles for family office and fund manager mandates. The VCC's key advantages over Cayman SPC structures: Singapore DTA access, no requirement for BVI/Cayman parallel vehicles, lower annual compliance cost (SGD 8,000–15,000 vs SGD 25,000–40,000 for offshore equivalents) [Kira estimates], and MAS regulatory familiarity for Singapore-based trustees and administrators.

S13O / S13U TAX INCENTIVES

Section 13O (onshore fund scheme, previously 13R) and Section 13U (enhanced tier fund scheme) remain the primary incentive mechanisms for family offices. As of January 2023, MAS tightened qualifying conditions: **13O requires a minimum AUM of SGD 10 mn** at application and SGD 20 mn within two years, plus at least one professional team member in Singapore. S13U requires SGD 50 mn AUM minimum [MAS 2023 Circular].

The January 2023 tightening reduced annual new applications from approximately 400 (2021 peak) to roughly 200–220 annually in 2023–2024 [Kira estimates], filtering out thin-capital structures while reinforcing substantive economic activity requirements. This regulatory calibration — raising the bar without closing the door — is widely read by industry participants as a deliberate quality-over-quantity signal from MAS.

CATALYST: SOUTH ASIAN HNWI RELOCATION WAVE

Post-2022, Indian entrepreneurs and corporates have represented **the single largest new-applicant cohort for S13O/13U incentives**, overtaking Greater China applicants for the first time [Kira estimates based on MAS sector briefings]. Drivers include India's capital gains tax environment, Singapore's legal system predictability, and proximity to Southeast Asian operating businesses.

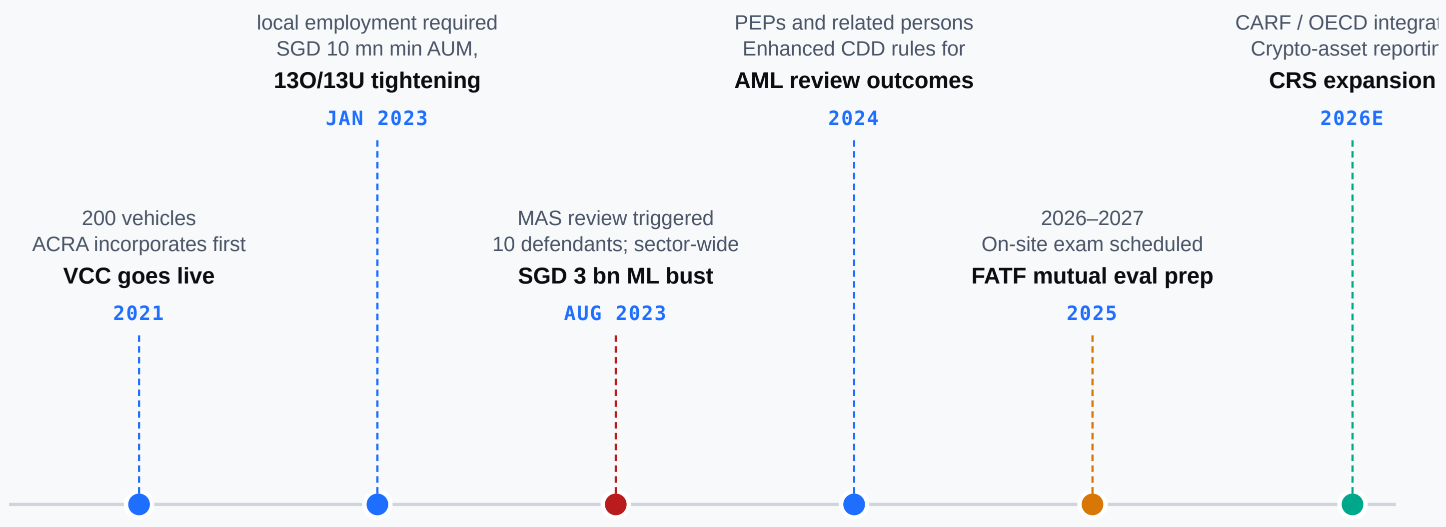
SOURCE KEY · **MAS 2025** = MAS Fund Manager Survey · **ACRA 2025** = ACRA VCC Register · **MAS 2023 Circular** = MAS 13O/13U Tightening Circular Jan 2023

Regulatory tightening: AML/CFT, CRS, and MAS supervision 2023–2026

MAS has intensified AML/CFT enforcement materially since 2022. The 2023 money-laundering case — involving SGD 3+ bn seized across 10 defendants — triggered a sector-wide review that reshaped compliance expectations for every category of wealth manager.

Singapore wealth management — regulatory milestone timeline

KEY MAS ACTIONS · 2021–2026



AML · HIGH PRIORITY

Source-of-wealth documentation

MAS now expects all **RFMCs and LFMCs** to document beneficial ownership to natural-person level and verify source of wealth for capital above SGD 500K [MAS Notice CMG-N02 2024].

[MAS CMG-N02 2024]

CRS · MEDIUM-TERM

Crypto-Asset Reporting Framework

OECD CARF obligates Singapore to expand CRS reporting to digital asset accounts. MAS consultation paper expected Q3 2026, with mandatory reporting from 2027 [OECD CARF 2025].

[OECD CARF 2025]

LICENSING · ONGOING

RFMC vs LFMC threshold review

MAS review of the SGD 250 mn AUM ceiling for Registered Fund Management Company status is ongoing. **A raise to SGD 500 mn** would exempt a larger cohort from full CMS licensing costs [MAS 2025 Consultation].

[MAS 2025 CONSULTATION]

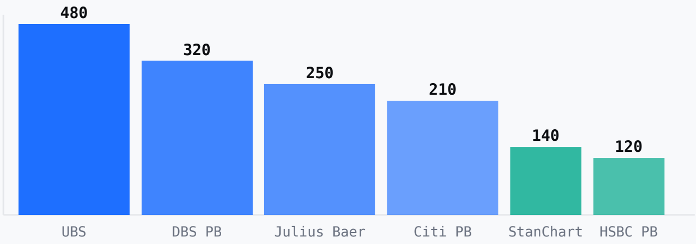
SOURCE KEY · **MAS CMG-N02 2024** = MAS Notice CMG-N02 on AML/CFT, July 2024 · **OECD CARF 2025** = OECD Crypto-Asset Reporting Framework, 2025 update

Private banking: headcount race, fee compression, and the AUM-per-RM constraint

Private banking AUM by institution — Singapore booking centre

USD BN

USD BN ESTIMATE · 2024 · SELECTED INSTITUTIONS



SOURCE: OPERATOR ANNUAL REPORTS 2024; KIRA ESTIMATES FOR BOOKING-CENTRE ALLOCATION

Headcount dynamics

Total relationship manager (RM) headcount in Singapore private banking reached approximately **8,500–9,000** by end-2024 [Kira estimates based on MAS and IBF data]. The ratio of RM to AUM has deteriorated as AUM growth outpaced hiring — average AUM per RM now approaches USD 170 mn, up from USD 110 mn in 2020.

RM headcount SG 2024	**~8,800**
Avg AUM / RM	**USD 170 mn**
Avg revenue / RM	**USD 1.2–1.5 mn**
RM attrition rate 2024	**~18%**

MARKET LEADER

RANK 01 · SWISS UNIVERSAL

UBS Private Bank

Singapore booking centre; APAC HQ

AUM (SG booking)	**~USD 480 bn**
RM count SG	**~700**

Strengths: deepest product shelf, ultra-HNW positioning, post-CS merger book absorption.

RANK 02 · LOCAL CHAMPION

DBS Private Bank

DBS Group Holdings

AUM (PB segment)	**~USD 320 bn**
RM count SG	**~500**

Strengths: strongest Southeast Asian distribution, digital banking integration, family office advisory.

RANK 03 · SWISS SPECIALIST

Julius Baer Asia

Julius Baer Group

AUM (Asia)	**~USD 250 bn**
RM count APAC	**~450**

Strengths: pure-play private banking; strong North and Southeast Asian HNWI penetration.

RANK 04 · US GLOBAL

Citi Private Bank

Citigroup

AUM (APAC)	**~USD 210 bn**
RM count SG	**~320**

Strengths: USD credit facilities, ultra-HNW (USD 25 mn+) focus, strong Indian diaspora coverage.

SOURCE KEY · **Operator AR 2024** = UBS, DBS, Julius Baer, Citi published annual reports · **Kira estimates** for SG booking centre allocation where not disclosed

Singapore vs Hong Kong: structurally differentiated, not directly competing

DIVERGING CAPITAL PROFILES

The common framing of a Singapore–Hong Kong zero-sum competition mischaracterises the structural reality. **Hong Kong's 2,700+ licensed asset managers** are disproportionately mainland China-linked — serving Chinese equities mandates, H-share portfolios, and Greater Bay Area family capital [SFC 2025]. Singapore's 1,100+ fund managers serve a geographically diversified mix: Southeast Asian, South Asian, global diaspora, and Middle Eastern capital.

Post-2020 relocations — of both capital and individuals — were predominantly geopolitically motivated: regulatory unpredictability in Hong Kong during 2019–2021 drove a cohort of international operators toward Singapore. That cohort is unlikely to reverse. **Over 60% of Singapore's post-2021 family office registrations cite rule-of-law certainty as a primary locational factor** [Kira estimates based on EDB surveys].

WHERE SG LEADS

- **VCC structuring advantage:** no Hong Kong equivalent for single-family vehicle incorporation with DTA access
- **Southeast Asian deal access:** proximity, bilateral treaties, and operational presence in ASEAN markets
- **Legal system:** common law, SICC, international arbitration infrastructure
- **Political neutrality:** perceived as non-aligned relative to geopolitical fault lines

WHERE HK RETAINS ADVANTAGES

- **Mainland China access:** Southbound Stock Connect, Bond Connect, direct capital market linkage
- **Chinese currency products:** CNH bond issuance, dim sum bond market depth
- **Greater Bay Area proximity:** Shenzhen tech capital, Guangdong manufacturing wealth
- **IPO pipeline:** HKEX remains the dominant Asia listing venue for mainland corporates

COMPETITIVE FLASHPOINTS

The real contest in 2026 is not AUM share but **talent acquisition**. Both centres are competing for a narrow global talent pool of experienced private bankers, compliance officers, and family office advisors. Singapore's work pass regime (EP, PDSI) has remained more accessible than Hong Kong's post-2020 environment, giving it an operational advantage in professional hiring.

Hong Kong's August 2023 New Capital Investment Entrant Scheme — attracting HKD 30 mn+ investors — reflects a deliberate policy to match Singapore's S13O/13U incentive. **Initial uptake was below government projections** (approximately 400 applications in H2 2023 vs a 3,000-per-year target) [HKID 2024], suggesting Singapore's head start in family office infrastructure is not easily replicated on a policy-announcement timeline.

OUTLOOK

The two centres are likely to specialise further rather than converge. Singapore consolidates as the preferred booking centre for ASEAN, South Asian, and geopolitically risk-averse capital. Hong Kong retains primacy for mainland-linked investment flows. The 2026–2028 period will test whether Hong Kong's CIES uptick and Singapore's compliance tightening shift the balance — our analysts' base case is that the structural gap in their respective capital profiles widens, not narrows.

SOURCE KEY · **SFC 2025** = Hong Kong SFC Asset Management Survey 2025 · **HKID 2024** = HKSAR Investment Entry Scheme statistics 2024

Digital assets integration: custody, tokenisation, and the MAS licensing perimeter

MAS PSA MPI LICENCES ISSUED	FO DIGITAL ASSET ALLOCATION	PROJECT GUARDIAN ASSETS TOKENISED	SG CRYPTO FUND AUM EST.
28	35–40 %	USD 1.5 bn+	USD 8–12 bn
Digital token service providers, 2024	Hold or plan to hold within 18 months	Pilot phase; institutional participation	Licensed and unlicensed, 2024
[MAS 2025]	[KIRA ESTIMATES]	[MAS 2025]	[KIRA ESTIMATES]

MAS LICENSING FRAMEWORK FOR DIGITAL ASSETS

MAS administers digital token services under the Payment Services Act (PSA) 2019, amended in 2021. Entities providing digital payment token (DPT) services — exchange, transfer, custody — require a Major Payment Institution (MPI) licence. **28 MPI licences were in force by end-2024** [MAS 2025], covering operators including Independent Reserve, Coinbase Singapore, and licensed custody providers.

Family offices seeking direct Bitcoin or Ethereum custody face a choice: use an MPI-licensed custodian (e.g. Anchorage Digital, Copper Technologies) or operate via a managed account with an exempt fund manager. The former is preferred by institutional family offices with compliance officers; the latter by smaller SFOs prioritising operational simplicity.

PROJECT GUARDIAN AND TOKENISATION

MAS's Project Guardian — a collaborative initiative with financial institutions — has piloted tokenised fund issuance, tokenised bonds, and tokenised foreign exchange. By 2025, **over USD 1.5 bn in institutional assets** had been tokenised across pilots involving UBS, DBS, HSBC, and JPMorgan [MAS 2025]. The practical significance for wealth management: fractional ownership of illiquid assets (private equity, real estate) via token structures offers secondary liquidity for family office portfolios otherwise locked in 7–10 year fund cycles.

PRIVATE BANK DIGITAL ASSET PRODUCT BUILD-OUT

DBS Digital Exchange (DDEx) — launched 2020, restricted to institutional and accredited investors — is the most advanced private bank-linked digital asset venue in Singapore. It offers **security token issuance, digital asset custody, and a secondary market** for tokenised private market instruments [DBS AR 2024]. The model is being watched closely by regional peers deciding whether to build, partner, or white-label digital asset capabilities.

UBS and Julius Baer have taken a more cautious approach — both offering managed exposure to crypto via structured products (capital-protected notes linked to Bitcoin/ETH) rather than direct custody. This conservative positioning reflects the still-evolving regulatory perimeter and reputational risk considerations for traditional private banking clients.

CARF INTEGRATION TIMELINE

The OECD Crypto-Asset Reporting Framework (CARF) — which obligates Singapore to exchange digital asset transaction data with treaty partners — is expected to enter Singapore law via MAS consultation by Q3 2026. For family offices and their service providers, this effectively brings crypto holdings into the same reporting and disclosure environment as traditional financial accounts. **The compliance build required for CARF reporting is non-trivial**, particularly for family offices that have accumulated digital assets informally or via offshore vehicles without a clean chain of title.

SOURCE KEY · **MAS 2025** = MAS PSA licensing register + Project Guardian update · **DBS AR 2024** = DBS Group Annual Report 2024

Next-gen succession: the governance gap and wealth transfer economics

SCALE OF THE TRANSFER WAVE

BCG's 2025 Global Wealth Report projects that **approximately 60% of Asia-Pacific UHNW wealth will transfer to the next generation by 2035** [BCG 2025]. For Singapore-domiciled family offices — skewed toward first-generation entrepreneurs whose businesses monetised between 2015 and 2023 — this transfer timeline is compressed: a significant cohort of founders is in their 60s–70s with G2 members in their 30s–40s, creating an active near-term succession window.

The median Singapore family office was established post-2018 [Kira estimates based on MAS incorporation data], meaning most are less than 7 years old. Governance structures that were adequate for a founder-controlled single-person investment vehicle are frequently inadequate for multi-beneficiary, multi-generation management — a gap service providers are actively targeting.

COMMON GOVERNANCE FAILURE MODES

- **Absent investment policy statements:** no documented risk tolerance, asset allocation or veto rights for non-founder beneficiaries
- **Single point of operational dependency:** founder as sole signatory for capital decisions, creating probate risk
- **No family charter:** disputes over distributions, philanthropy, and in-family lending resolved ad hoc
- **Unstructured G2 integration:** next-gen family members excluded from investment committees until succession crisis forces inclusion

NEXT-GEN INVESTMENT PREFERENCES

Surveys of G2/G3 family office beneficiaries in Singapore consistently show a preference shift toward **impact investing, venture capital, and digital assets** versus the founder generation's preference for private equity, real estate, and fixed income [Campden Wealth 2024]. The practical friction: investment committees dominated by founders routinely veto alternative allocations, creating talent retention risk for family offices that hire G2 members in junior advisory roles.

The allocation divergence is large: G2 beneficiaries surveyed by Campden Wealth allocated on average **22% of their personal investable assets to alternatives including crypto and impact**, versus 9% for the founder generation [Campden Wealth 2024]. Private banks and family office advisors who can build bridges — structuring impact co-investments, tokenised venture exposures, and blended mandates — will be better positioned to retain AUM across the generational handoff.

SERVICE PROVIDER OPPORTUNITY

Legal and corporate governance advisory, family office consolidation (SFO-to-MFO migration as scale justifies shared services), and succession-specialist trust companies are experiencing **above-average pipeline growth in 2025–2026** [Kira estimates]. The Singapore trust company sector — regulated under the Trust Companies Act — counts 58 licensed operators, with HSBC Trustee, Butterfield Trust, and Zedra among the most active in family office mandates.

Notably, philanthropic structures — donor-advised funds (DAFs) and charitable trusts established in Singapore — are a governance mechanism increasingly used to give G2 members **meaningful capital stewardship responsibility** before full succession. The Community Foundation of Singapore and the National Volunteer and Philanthropy Centre report a 35% increase in new donor-advised fund registrations since 2022 [NVPC 2024].

SOURCE KEY · **BCG 2025** = BCG Global Wealth Report 2025 · **Campden Wealth 2024** = Campden Wealth Asia Family Office Survey 2024 · **NVPC 2024** = National Volunteer and Philanthropy Centre

Five-year outlook: base case SGD 9 trn AUM by 2030, with three scenario divergences

BASE CASE (PROBABILITY: 55%)

Singapore maintains its AML/CFT FATF rating at the 2026–27 mutual evaluation, family office formation stabilises at 150–200 net additions per year (post-2023 quality filter), and AUM compounds at 8–10% annually. **Total managed AUM reaches SGD 8.5–9.0 trn by 2030** [Kira estimates], with private equity/alternatives displacing traditional long-only to represent 35% of the total mix. The VCC vehicle count surpasses 2,500. Singapore remains the preferred booking centre for South and Southeast Asian family capital.

UPSIDE SCENARIO (PROBABILITY: 25%)

A material escalation of geopolitical risk in the Taiwan Strait or a Chinese capital controls event triggers a second wave of UHNW relocation toward Singapore analogous to 2020–2021. Annual family office registrations reaccelerate to 350–400. AUM reaches **SGD 11–12 trn by 2030** [Kira estimates], but talent and compliance infrastructure face severe strain. MAS likely intervenes with further entry requirements to manage reputational risk from compliance quality dilution.

DOWNSIDE SCENARIO (PROBABILITY: 20%)

A FATF non-compliant or partially-compliant rating at the 2026–27 mutual evaluation, combined with a major domestic money-laundering case at comparable scale to 2023, triggers fund manager relocations to Dubai, Luxembourg, or Geneva. **AUM growth flatlines** at 3–4% CAGR. Net new family office registrations fall below 50 per year as HNWI applicants divert to alternative jurisdictions. Recovery path requires 12–18 months of regulatory remediation and reputational rebuild.

STRUCTURAL DEMAND DRIVERS (ALL SCENARIOS)

- **Southeast Asian wealth creation:** Indonesia, Vietnam, and Thailand middle-market entrepreneurial liquidity events will generate 300–500 new family office candidates annually through 2030 [Kira estimates]
- **South Asian diaspora deepening:** Indian HNWIs continue to use Singapore as the primary offshore wealth hub; NRI community exceeds 350,000 in SG [MOM 2025]
- **Interest rate cycle:** falling USD/SGD interest rate differentials reduce the carry cost of SGD-domiciled structures, making Singapore competitive against USD booking centres
- **ASEAN Economic Community integration:** deepening ASEAN capital markets create investment deal flow justifying SG-domiciled fund structures for intraregional mandates

KEY RISKS TO MONITOR IN 2026

- **FATF mutual evaluation outcome** — single highest-impact event for Singapore's reputation
- **MAS RFMC threshold revision** — could shift 200–300 entities between licensing categories, affecting compliance cost structures
- **CARF implementation timeline** — digital asset reporting obligations will reshape family office portfolio disclosure practice
- **Hong Kong CIES uptake** — if meaningful scale materialises (10,000+ applicants), HK regains competitive pressure in the UHNW segment
- **Geopolitical shock scenario** — a Taiwan escalation creates upside for SG but tests infrastructure capacity

COMPETITIVE POSITIONING ADVICE

Market participants entering or expanding in Singapore's wealth management sector in 2026 should prioritise three capabilities: **institutional-grade AML/CDD infrastructure, digital asset product access, and next-gen governance advisory services**. These three vectors address the sector's most immediate compliance requirement, its fastest-growing allocation category, and its most structurally important retention challenge simultaneously.

SOURCE KEY · **MOM 2025** = Ministry of Manpower Employment Pass statistics · **Kira estimates** for forward projections and scenario probabilities

Source key, data notes, and disclosures

PRIMARY SOURCES

- **MAS 2025** — Monetary Authority of Singapore, Singapore Asset Management Survey 2025. Published annually, covers licensed and registered fund managers; data as of end-2024.
- **ACRA 2025** — Accounting and Corporate Regulatory Authority, Variable Capital Companies register as of Q1 2025.
- **MAS CMG-N02 2024** — MAS Notice on Prevention of Money Laundering and Countering the Financing of Terrorism for Capital Markets Intermediaries, revised July 2024.
- **IRAS 2025** — Inland Revenue Authority of Singapore, Double Taxation Agreement schedule and Section 13O/13U administrative guidance, 2025 edition.
- **MAS 2023 Circular** — MAS Circular on Enhancement of Section 13O and 13U Fund Tax Incentive Schemes, January 2023.
- **MAS 2025 Consultation** — MAS Consultation Paper on Proposed Revisions to the Fund Manager Regulatory Framework, Q1 2025.
- **MOM 2025** — Ministry of Manpower Employment Pass and Singapore Permanent Resident statistics, 2025 Annual Report.
- **NVPC 2024** — National Volunteer and Philanthropy Centre, Giving Report 2024.

SECONDARY AND OPERATOR SOURCES

- **BCG 2025** — BCG Global Wealth Report 2025. HNWI population, wealth transfer projections, offshore share.
- **SFC 2025** — Hong Kong SFC, Asset and Wealth Management Activities Survey 2025.
- **HKID 2024** — HKSAR Immigration Department, CIES scheme statistics 2024.
- **Campden Wealth 2024** — Campden Wealth, Asia Pacific Family Office Report 2024.
- **DBS AR 2024** — DBS Group Annual Report 2024. DDEx disclosures.
- **Operator AR 2024** — UBS, Julius Baer, Citigroup Annual Reports 2024.
- **OECD CARF 2025** — OECD Crypto-Asset Reporting Framework, 2025 update.

DATA NOTES AND METHODOLOGY

AUM figures: Singapore total managed AUM (SGD 5.4 trn) is drawn directly from MAS's published Asset Management Survey, which covers all licensed and registered fund managers in Singapore regardless of domicile. This figure includes assets managed in Singapore across all asset classes; it is not confined to Singapore-domiciled funds.

Family office count: MAS does not publish a real-time family office register. The 1,400+ figure is a widely cited MAS estimate as of end-2024, publicly stated by MAS Managing Director Chia Der Jiun in January 2025. KIRA corroborates this against ACRA corporate filings and sector associations.

Private bank AUM: Booking-centre level private bank AUM is not systematically reported. KIRA's estimates are derived from operator annual reports, supplemented by cross-checks against disclosed APAC private banking net new money figures and regional headcount. These figures carry estimation uncertainty of ±15–20%.

Kira estimates: All figures tagged [Kira estimates] are KIRA Research analyst constructions — bottom-up models, triangulation from publicly available data, or extrapolations from a stated anchoring figure. These are directional; they should not be used as audit-grade figures.

DISCLOSURES

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